Employee Handbook (United States)

Version 5.1 - Effective 6 January 2025

Owner: People Team (HR)

1. Welcome to Kitewing

Kitewing Software builds scheduling and route-planning tools for mid-sized delivery companies. This handbook explains the policies that apply to employees of Kitewing Software Inc. in the United States. Employees of Kitewing Software Ltd in the United Kingdom should read their own edition of this handbook instead.

If anything in this handbook is unclear, ask your manager or contact the People Team at people@kitewing.example. Where this handbook and your employment contract differ, your contract applies.

2. Working at Kitewing

2.1 Employment status

Employment with Kitewing Software Inc. is at-will. This means that either you or Kitewing may end the employment relationship at any time, with or without notice, subject to applicable law. Nothing in this handbook creates a contract of employment.

2.2 Probation

New employees complete a 90-day introductory period. Your manager will hold a check-in with you after 30 days and a formal review at the end of the 90 days.

2.3 Working hours

Our standard full-time schedule is 40 hours per week. Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in your local time zone, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours you may arrange your working day with your manager. Non-exempt employees must record all hours worked in PeopleHub, including any overtime, which must be approved in advance.

2.4 Hybrid and remote work

Most roles at Kitewing are hybrid. The rules for anchor days, fully remote working and working from another country are set out in the Remote Work Policy on The Perch.

2.5 Pay

You are paid twice a month, on the 15th and on the last working day of the month, by direct deposit. Payslips are available in PeopleHub. If you think there is a mistake in your pay, report it to payroll@kitewing.example within 30 days so that it can be corrected in the next pay run.

2.6 Performance reviews

Kitewing holds performance reviews twice a year, in April and October. Before each review you complete a short self-assessment in PeopleHub, and your manager gathers feedback from two or three colleagues you work closely with. Ratings are calibrated across each department so that they are applied consistently. Pay increases and promotions are decided once a year, after the April review.

2.7 Learning and development

Every employee has a learning budget of $1,500 per calendar year for courses, books, certifications and conference tickets. Request learning spend in PeopleHub Learning before you book; your manager approves it. Unused budget does not carry over to the next year. If Kitewing pays more than $3,000 for a single course or certification and you leave within 12 months of completing it, you may be asked to repay part of the cost.

2.8 Business expenses

Business travel and other work expenses are covered by the Travel and Expense Policy on The Perch. Always check the current version of that policy before you book travel.

3. Time Off

3.1 Paid time off (PTO)

Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid time off (PTO) per calendar year. PTO accrues at 1.67 days per month and is prorated for part-time employees and for anyone who joins part-way through the year. PTO is used for vacation and personal time.

3.2 Requesting PTO

Request PTO in PeopleHub. For absences of three or more consecutive working days, submit your request at least two weeks in advance. Your manager will approve or decline the request within three working days. Requests for more than 10 consecutive working days also need approval from your department head.

3.3 Carrying over unused leave

You may carry over up to 5 unused PTO days into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March or they are forfeited. Unused PTO is paid out when you leave Kitewing where state law requires it.

3.4 Company holidays

Kitewing observes 10 paid company holidays each year in the US. The holiday calendar for the following year is published on The Perch each December.

3.5 Sick leave

You receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year, separate from PTO. Sick leave can be used for your own illness or injury, medical appointments, or to care for a family member. If you are absent for more than three consecutive working days, your manager may ask for a doctor's note.

3.6 Bereavement leave

If someone close to you dies, you can take up to 5 days of paid bereavement leave for an immediate family member (a partner, child, parent or sibling) and up to 2 days for other relatives. Tell your manager as soon as you can; you do not need to provide evidence. If you need more time, talk to your manager or the People Team about using other leave.

3.7 Jury duty

If you are called for jury duty, Kitewing pays your full base pay for up to 10 working days. Give your manager a copy of the summons as soon as you receive it, and record the days in PeopleHub as Jury Duty.

3.8 Unpaid personal leave

With your manager's approval, you can take up to 4 weeks of unpaid personal leave in a calendar year, once you have used your PTO. Your benefits continue during unpaid leave of up to 4 weeks. Longer unpaid leave needs approval from the People Team.

3.9 Sabbatical

After 5 years of continuous service, you can take a paid sabbatical of 4 weeks, in addition to your normal leave. The sabbatical must be taken within 2 years of becoming eligible, and agreed with your manager at least 3 months in advance.

4. Parental Leave

4.1 Purpose

Kitewing supports employees who are welcoming a new child into their family through birth, adoption, foster placement or surrogacy. This section explains who is eligible, how much leave is available, and how to apply.

4.2 Eligibility

To be eligible for paid parental leave, you must have completed at least 12 months of continuous service with Kitewing on the expected date of birth or placement. You must also be a regular employee scheduled to work at least 30 hours per week. Birth parents, non-birth parents, adoptive parents and foster parents are all eligible. Contractors, interns and temporary staff are not eligible for paid parental leave, but may be entitled to unpaid leave under federal or state law.

4.3 How much leave you receive

Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of paid parental leave at 100% of base pay. Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks of paid parental leave at 100% of base pay. The primary caregiver is the parent with the main day-to-day responsibility for the child during the leave period. Leave must be taken within 12 months of the birth or placement. You may take your leave in one continuous block or in up to two separate blocks of at least two weeks each.

4.4 Pay and benefits during leave

Your health, vision and life insurance benefits continue during paid parental leave on the same terms as when you are working. Kitewing continues to make 401(k) matching contributions on the pay you receive during leave. PTO continues to accrue during paid parental leave. Annual bonuses are prorated for the time you spend on leave.

4.5 How parental leave works with FMLA and state programs

Paid parental leave runs at the same time as any leave you are entitled to under the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). If you live in a state with a paid family leave program, such as California, New York or Washington, Kitewing pays the difference between the state benefit and your base pay, so that your total pay during the paid weeks is 100% of your base pay.

4.6 Returning to work

When you return, you will be placed in the same role or an equivalent role with the same pay. Returning parents may use a phased return: for up to four weeks you can work 60% of your normal schedule while receiving full pay. Agree the phased-return schedule with your manager before your leave ends.

4.7 How to apply

Submit a parental leave request in PeopleHub under Time Off > Leave of Absence > Parental Leave at least 30 days before your intended start date. If the birth or placement happens earlier than expected, submit the request as soon as you reasonably can. Attach a document showing the expected due date or placement date. Your HR Business Partner will confirm your leave dates and pay in writing within five working days. You should also tell your manager about your plans as early as you feel comfortable, so that cover can be arranged.

5. Conduct and Raising Concerns

5.1 Code of conduct

We expect everyone at Kitewing to treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect, to act honestly, and to protect company and customer information. The full Code of Conduct is on The Perch and must be acknowledged within 30 days of joining.

5.2 Reporting concerns

If you see something that concerns you, speak to your manager or the People Team. You can also report concerns anonymously through the Ethics Line on 1-800-555-0142 or at ethics@kitewing.example. Kitewing does not tolerate retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith.

5.3 Equipment and information security

Follow the Information Security Policy at all times. If your laptop or phone is lost or stolen, report it immediately using Form IT-412 in the KiteDesk portal.

5.4 Equal opportunity and anti-harassment

Kitewing is an equal opportunity employer. We make decisions about hiring, pay, promotion and development based on skills and performance, never on race, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, disability, or any other protected characteristic. Harassment and bullying are not tolerated. If you experience or witness harassment, report it to your manager, the People Team or the Ethics Line.

5.5 Dress code

There is no formal dress code. Dress appropriately for your day: smart casual is usual in the office, and business attire may be expected when you meet customers.

5.6 Social media

You are welcome to talk about working at Kitewing on social media, but you must not share Confidential information, speak on behalf of the company without approval from the Communications team, or post anything that harasses colleagues.

6. Workplace Safety

Report every accident, injury or near miss to your office manager on the same day, even if nobody was hurt. Each office has trained first aiders, listed by the kitchen. If you work from home, keep your workspace free of trip hazards and report any work-related injury to the People Team, because it may be covered by workers' compensation.

7. Leaving Kitewing

We ask for at least two weeks' written notice if you decide to leave Kitewing. Your final pay, including any PTO payout required by state law, is paid on the next regular payday. Return your laptop and any other equipment within five working days of your last day.

8. Key Contacts

People Team (HR): people@kitewing.example

Payroll: payroll@kitewing.example

Benefits: benefits@kitewing.example

IT Helpdesk: extension 4357 or the KiteDesk portal